Anzhelina & Karina
A new musical reading
September 21 & 22

Join us for a free reading of this original, heart-warming, musical presented by the New Musical Theater Exchange. After the show, you are invited to share your thoughts.

Sunday September 21 @ 2:30 pm
Monday September 22 @ 7:00 pm

Center for Performing Arts
3754 Pleasant Ave
Minneapolis, MN 55409

Benson

New York City, 1919
Two young Russian women reunite after a 10-year separation. The love they shared as children is soon lost as their differences become magnified by their turbulent new world. After witnessing street women in dire situations and a tragic event in New York history, they each take action to help.

Scan the code to learn more and reserve your free ticket(s).

To access the anonymous survey on-line

Scan this code on your computer, tablet, or phone

Or email us at bensonmailbox@comcast.net and we will send you a link to the survey

If you reserved tickets, we will automatically email the survey to you.

NEW MUSICAL THEATRE EXCHANGE

This show is in development with NMTE and the reading is an NMTE-sanctioned event.

Visit nmte.org to learn more about our organization.

The New Musical Theater Exchange is Excited to Present:

Anzhelina & Karina

New York City – lower east side, 1919

Cousins Anzhelina and Karina, inseparable as young children in Russia, reunite with great excitement after a 10-year separation. Karina, raised in a sheltered family, holds childhood fantasies of this "glamorous" place. Anzhelina, a field nurse in the Great War, sees through her war-torn eyes, a "wicked" place filled with poverty, prejudice, and oppression. Their opposing views quickly tear them apart. As they chart their paths and learn the truth about this often-perilous city, they also navigate challenges that could separate them forever, or bring them together again at last.

Cm - E Am - C# Fm - A.
Gm - B

Anzhelina & Karina

Book by Keith Benson

Actor	*Characters*
Robert Banks	Sergei, Officers
Thomas Berg	Boris, Henry (Pr L)
Michael Burton	Mario
Eric Heltemes	Nikolai
Nicole Korbisch	Rada, Louise
Ella Rose Katzenberger	Karina
Blanka Melbostad	Anzhelina
Zakary Morton	Viktor, Officers
Sri Peck	Rose, Effie
Jaezmyne Pheanious-Browne	Sadie, Anita
Mike Niles	Recorded Tracks
Brenda Varda	Director, Pianist

There are additional characters in the story, with small parts.

Omos
Hospital
prostitutes / tudolmir
anarchists /
leftist
Russian men?

Music

Keith Benson	Composer, Lyricist, Arranger
Bob Derus	Composer, Lyricist
Eric Heltemes	Orchestrator
Bill Kelm	Composer, Orchestrator
Marienne Kreitlow	Composer, Lyricist, Arranger
Mike Nilles	Composer, Lyricist
Brenda Varda	Arranger

Creators	*Act I Songs*
Keith, Eric	We Join Together: Prologue
Keith, Eric, Marienne	Here For You
Beautiful music *Keith, Eric*	My Dearest Friends
Keith, Eric	With You — why?
Keith, Mike, Bill	On Our Way why?
Keith, Marienne	We Join Together: Hospital
Keith, Marienne	Little One
Mike, Bob, Bill	Nostrovia
Keith, Brenda	I Wonder Why
Mike, Bill	Don't Get Dizzy with Me like hook
Keith, Brenda	When Will I Be Free — anoth slow
Keith, Eric	Anthem
Keith, Eric	With You: Reprise
Bill	Russian Dance Song

Creators	*Act II Songs*
Keith	Wall & Broad: Silent Movie ?
Keith	Gotta Love This Street! — why? — what are?
Keith, Marienne	She's Not the Girl I Knew — good
odd hook *Keith, Eric*	Look At Them Now — good — more philosophy issues.
Keith, Eric	100 Pounds of Dynamite
Keith	Requiem
Keith, Eric	100 Pounds of Dynamite: Repr.
Keith, Eric	With You: Reprise
Keith, Eric	New Hope — another sad one
Keith, Mike, Bill	On Our Way: Reprise
Keith, Eric	We Join Together: Country — ? close?
Keith, Eric	This Great Earth ?

nice harmony

Dialog editing: Bob Derus, Mike Nilles

1. Hard to understand lyrics at first - too wordy?
K - older
K - young | girls introduced - Not sure who they are
what they want?
The biggest problem at first is the lack of dramatic
conflict / urgency
first conflict - police
Why not activate A ignorant - we only hear about it?
lush arrangements - My Dearest Friends
energy felt lagging on with you - is it the right moment?
too much declamatory chorus - static - why?
On our way
We join together - where is the conflict - ??
Why not activate the conflict - musicalize her
doubts about obstetrics -
instead they sing we join together - she speaks -
then sings to baby?
Nostrovia - more declaiming but plot not moved -
What happened at hospital w/ men drinking? Not clear.
Wonder why - another sweet one - energy? what is her emotional state?
why is she singing it?
Nizy - desgetie - good
Anita - is she an informer? How knows cop?
I will be free - another slow one - pretty but...
Music is still too "power of two"
~~Why is K~~ Prostitute scene? why?
Too many anthems - then slow pretty ballads
the political climax - not built up enough -
Lacking emotional intensity
Why is A involved in union?
Why is K not involved in raid? key conflict / plot moment
It really isn't clear why the union got raided?
Nikolai deceived how? - drinking -
end act 1 - not dramatic -

Please share your strongest overall thoughts about *Anzhelina & Karina* with us. Write freely about anything you think might help improve the story or the songs. Below is a list of questions you can review to help shape your thoughts.

1. Central to the main struggle between the two young women was that Karina wanted to continue the relationship they enjoyed as children. However, Anzhelina was greatly changed by the war, and with the obsession to help the sick and dying (savior's complex). She could not give Karina the love she needed. **Were these messages clearly explained in the show?**

2. **Was it clear how Karina changed and adapted to live a purposeful and fulfilling life? Was her arc believable? Compelling?**

3. **Was it clear how Anzhelina healed from savior's complex and adapted to live a purposeful and fulfilling life? Was her arc believable? Was it compelling?**

4. True events of historical significance on the lower east side of Manhattan are highlighted in this show. But they are only helpful if they move Anzhelina or Karina's story forward and do not overtake it. **How successful was our story at weaving these major events within the fabric of Anzhelina and Karina's story?**

5. **ABOUT THE SHOW: What was your favorite part? What was your least favorite part? Did you find any parts confusing? Did the story end at a good place? Was the ending true to the story? Was it heartfelt, as was the intention for the ending?**

6. **ABOUT THE SONGS: Which song(s) fit well with the character's feelings in the moment and moved the story forward? Which song(s) failed to do so? Are there any favorite songs you would like to highlight? Are there issues with any of the songs that we should address?**

You may either turn this in at the door as you leave today, or you may follow the directions on the back of the program to fill out the survey online.

THANK YOU FOR COMING TODAY!

THANK YOU FOR SHARING YOUR THOUGHTS!

Act 2

too much happy village?

Who is Effie again? - news seller - can sell to anyone -

Why all get away? How?? Why is Louise w/A?

Why did K get mad? + leave?

Not enough exposition of conflict?

Not that girl has been done - hook reused -

concern for Rose ... too many people...

too many threads -

Prostitution theme - struggling with -

PLUS leftist violence?

Why is Nikolai sad? A demon was born? I don't know who he is even now. A demon born, that retreats in the face of love?

Why are Russian men closing?

at final Atk scene.

Angel of Wall (Bread -? She

Closing ... maybe show don't tell

Prosody -

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